

For application s like Games and Movies, the CRT still represents the best Visual Quality you can get

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The choice of most home users, 90 per cent of gamers, and movie buffs is still the bulky old CRT.

CRTs need to be set up properly. It's time to calibrate it when you have a dark-looking image on your screen, or if you feel your CRT isn't displaying colours as well as it should.

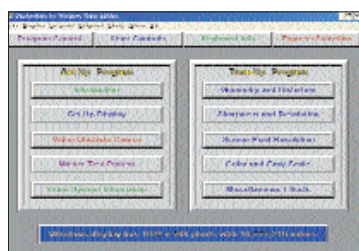
We jump into the fray and help you setup your display!

The Software

We will use DisplayMate to calibrate our test CRT. This software is precise, and gives you a step-by-step explanation window, which explains what the next display window will achieve by means of tuning, and what you need to watch out for. This help window alternates with the actual calibration pane, where you can tune the settings. It is available for download at www.displaymate.com. The registered download with the manual costs \$69 (Rs 3,300).

The Procedure

1. Install Display Mate. We ran the program with the "Novice" option disabled. After running Display Mate, the startup screen should look as below. Click on the "Set Up Display" button. We have refrained from explaining in depth what exactly each step does, as there is a very intuitive help window, so you will not have any problems.



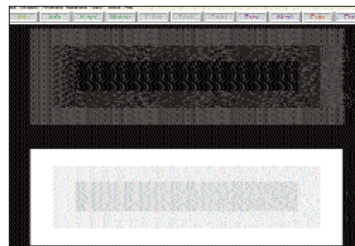
The DisplayMate main window

2. The next window will give you a brief intro. Click as directed onscreen. You are taken to a window that shows you exactly what the next test will accomplish, what you should look out for, and what problems you may face, along with possible solutions. Read the page carefully.

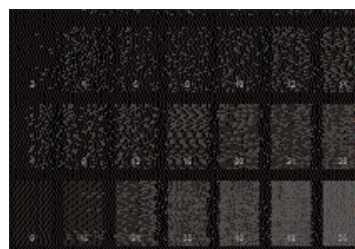
3. The first test is all about getting the Brightness and Contrast settings right. Follow the instructions on-screen. It's a good idea to jot down what you have to do, because you might have to refer back to the process explained in the previous page, which can get a bit irritating!

4. The next step ensures that the lightest and darkest shades of white and grey are properly reproduced and faithfully represented by what you see. As with step 3, read carefully and then tune!

5. Ensuring the monitor's blackness level is perfect (or close to that) is the next part of the calibration process. This test shows you a number of blocks on the screen with varying shades of grey. You need to tune your brightness settings so as to ensure that



Checking colour gradation levels



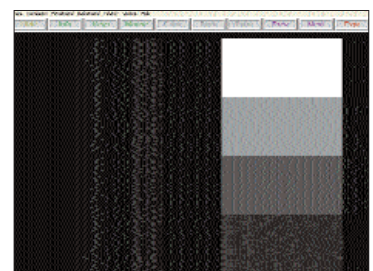
Get as many dark grey boxes as possible when calibrating

the maximum number of blocks appear dark grey while ensuring the background remains black.

6. The next tweak is the well known ANSI greyscale pattern test. This is to ensure that the extremes of the greyscale are properly reproduced. Two boxes are shown, with colours ranging from Black represented by 0, to White, represented by 100. You need to adjust the brightness/contrast settings so that the two middle boxes—5 and 95—are distinct from the others.

7. The next step deals with setting a black level and playing around with the whiteness level. This step actually has two screens, (the left half of the screen will remain constant displaying two dark grey strips. The first screen will, (on the right-hand side), have four varying levels of grey, ranging from dark grey to white; the second screen will have a full-intensity white bar that takes up half the screen. You need to adjust the monitor brightness until you can just see both the vertical strips, (ones on the left). The background should remain black. The White bar should not appear distorted, and the dark (vertical) strips should look identical on both the greyscale and the white pages.

8. The test in this step involves ensuring that the brightest image detail remains as sharp as possible. As all high-intensity beams tend to defocus, leading to what is called the "Bloom" effect (the halo



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